

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

# Modern, Czech, Snake, and Blumenfeld Benoni Systems

Use space, restrain Black's breaks, and convert the central wedge into active play

TRAINING WORKBOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

# Workbook Method

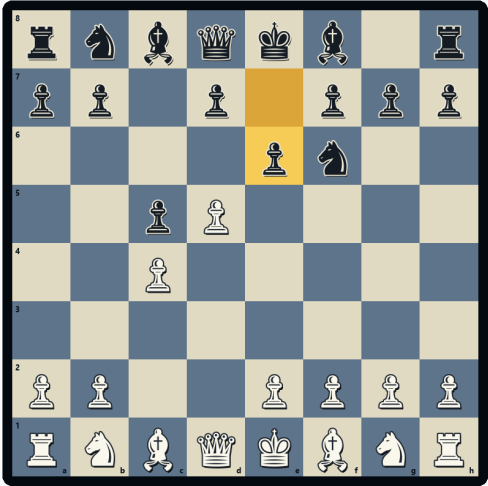
Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

## REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

# 01. Modern Benoni Core - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Modern Benoni Core structure while preserving White's central options.

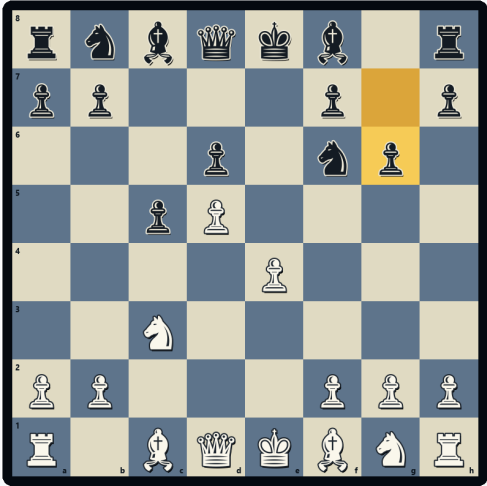
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 02. Modern Benoni Core



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

White owns central space while Black gains active diagonals and queenside breaks.

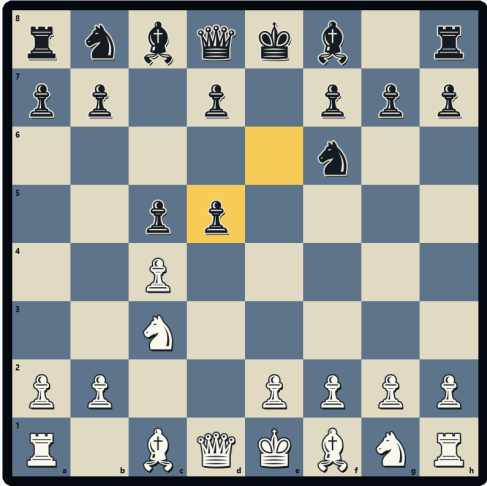
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 03. Classical Benoni Development - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Classical Benoni Development structure while preserving White's central options.

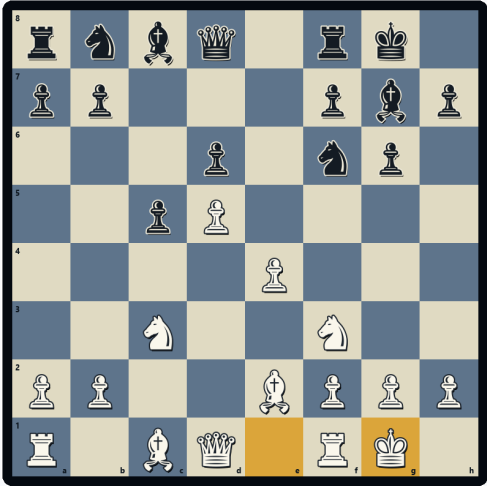
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 04. Classical Benoni Development



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

White develops safely behind the central wedge and keeps several plans available.

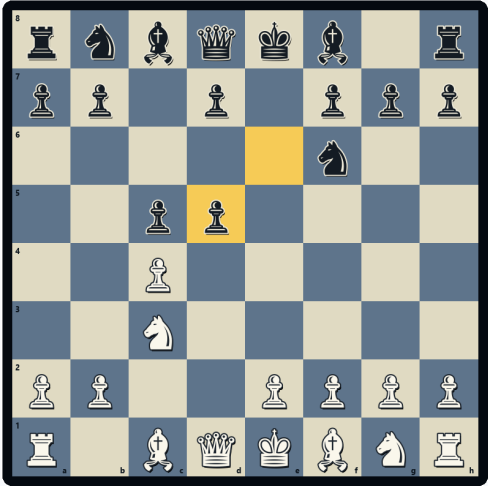
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 05. Fianchetto Benoni - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Fianchetto Benoni structure while preserving White's central options.

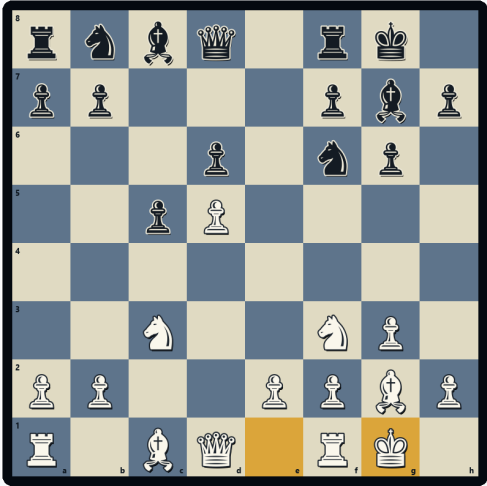
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 06. Fianchetto Benoni



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

White uses the long diagonal to reduce Black's queenside activity.

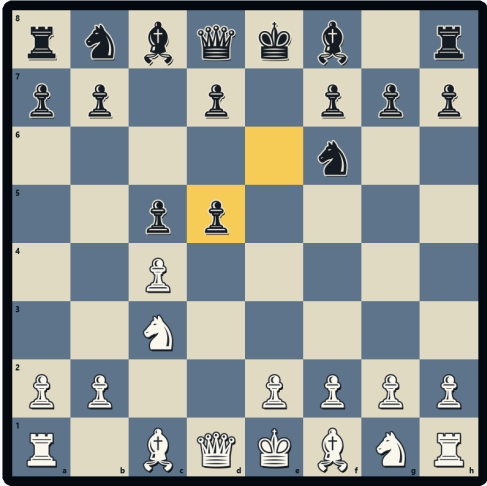
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. Nf3 g6 7. g3 Bg7 8. Bg2 O-O 9. O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 07. Taimanov Benoni Check - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Taimanov Benoni Check structure while preserving White's central options.

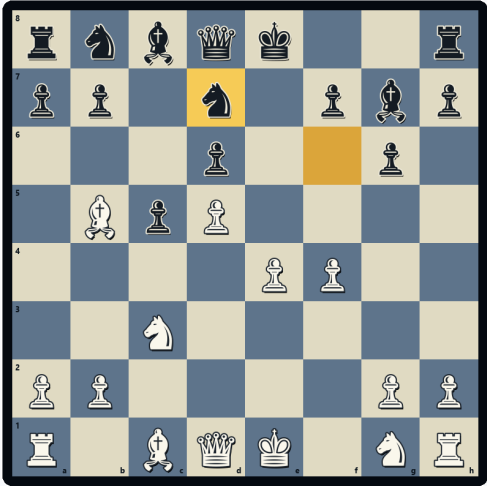
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 08. Taimanov Benoni Check



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

White uses a check to disrupt Black's normal development and supports an aggressive center.

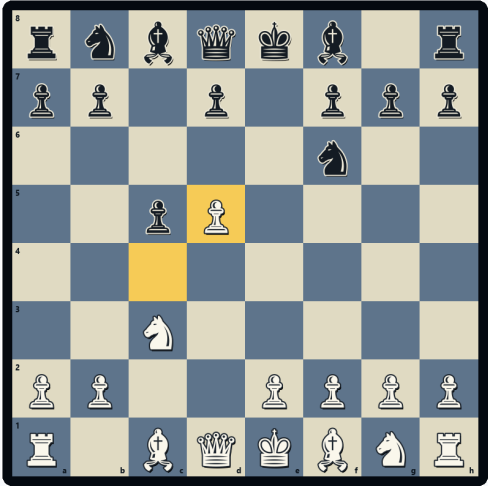
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. f4 Bg7 8. Bb5+ Nfd7

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 09. Benoni Knight Route - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Benoni Knight Route structure while preserving White's central options.

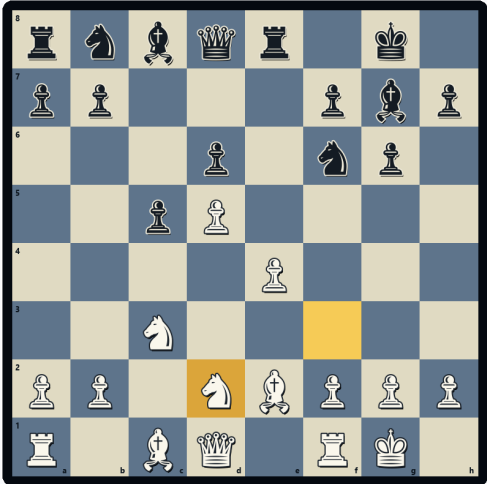
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 10. Benoni Knight Route



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

The d2-knight aims for c4, where it pressures d6 and supports queenside play.

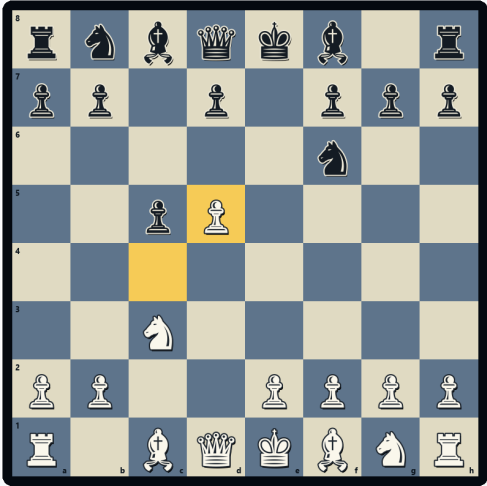
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O Re8 10. Nd2

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 11. Stop the ...b5 Break - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Stop the ...b5 Break structure while preserving White's central options.

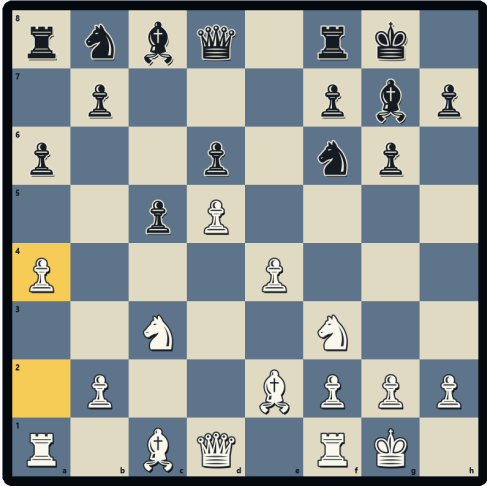
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 12. Stop the ...b5 Break



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Black announces queenside expansion; White fixes b5 before it gains space.

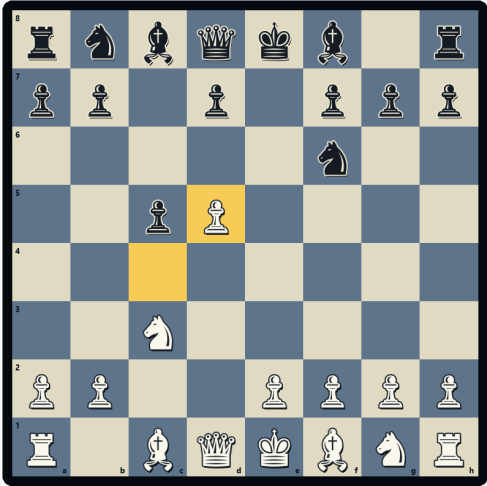
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O a6 10. a4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 13. The e5 Space Break - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the The e5 Space Break structure while preserving White's central options.

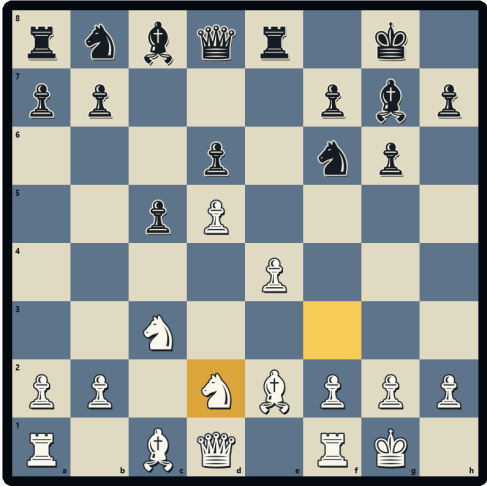
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 14. The e5 Space Break



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

White may prepare e5 to open lines and dislodge the f6-knight.

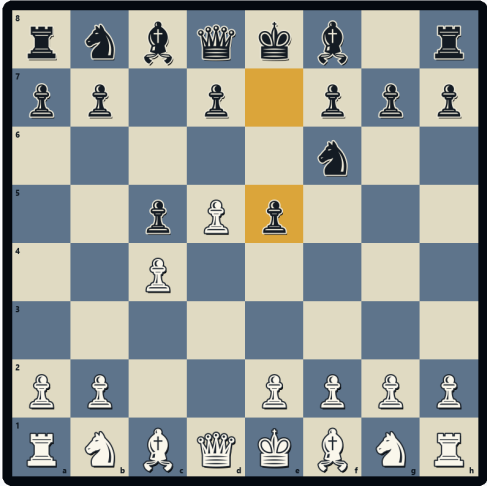
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O Re8 10. Nd2

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 15. Czech Benoni - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Czech Benoni structure while preserving White's central options.

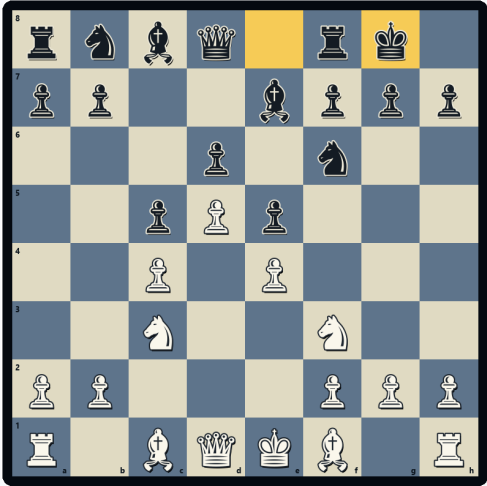
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 16. Czech Benoni



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Black closes the center with ...e5 and concedes space for a compact structure.

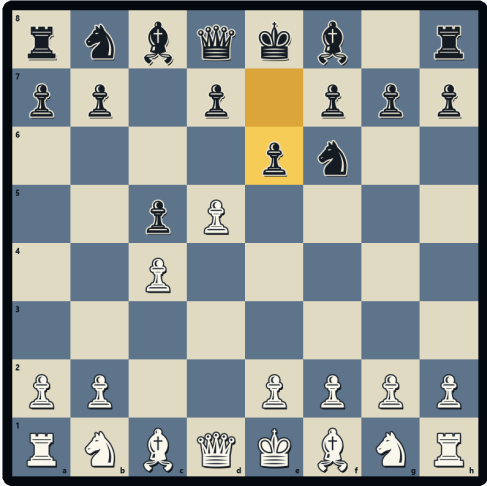
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e5 4. Nc3 d6 5. e4 Be7 6. Nf3 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 17. Snake Benoni - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Snake Benoni structure while preserving White's central options.

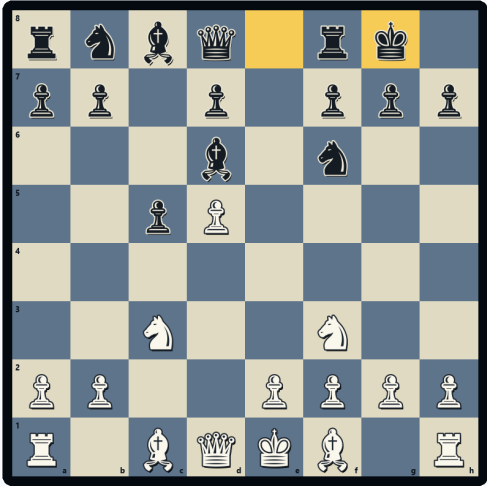
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 18. Snake Benoni



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Black develops the bishop to d6 before ...d6 and aims directly at h2.

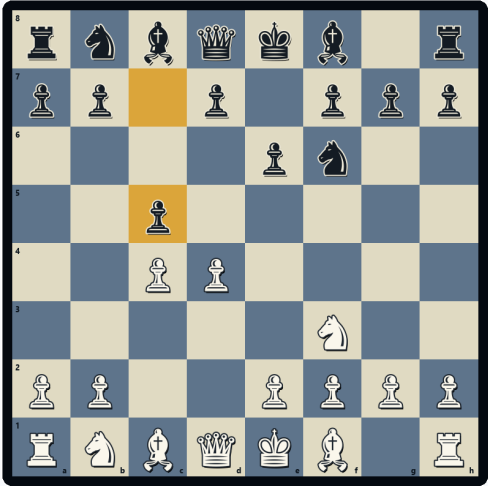
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 Bd6 6. Nf3 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 19. Blumenfeld Countergambit - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Reach the Blumenfeld Countergambit structure while preserving White's central options.

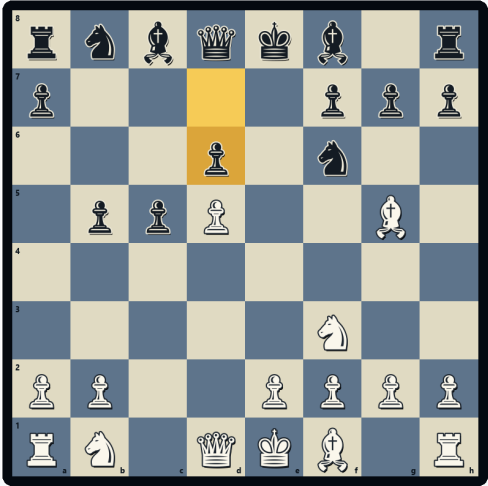
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 20. Blumenfeld Countergambit



BENONI SYSTEMS

POSITION PROMPT

Black offers a queenside pawn to build a broad center and open lines.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 b5 5. Bg5 exd5 6. cxd5 d6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
4. Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
5. What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.